

AP Exception Taxonomy v1.0

One primary code per item. Secondary codes allowed.

Product	AP Agent OS
Tier	Professional
Version	1.0
Date	September 2026
Use	Implementation toolkit

Responsibility is earned.

How to use

Code the presenting problem, not the suspected personality of the buyer. Root cause is a separate field. Escalation is a role, not a name.

Risk: L = low operational, M = medium (cash/supplier), H = high (control, payment, fraud-adjacent, financial reporting).

Automation potential: D = deterministic, A = agent assist, H = human judgment.

Codes

Code	Name	Definition	Probable root cause	Required data	Suggested resolution	Responsible	Escalation	Agent	Auto	Risk
EX-PO-MISS	Missing PO	Invoice has no usable PO and policy requires one	Supplier skipped PO; requester bought off-contract	Invoice, policy, requester clues	Request PO or route as non-PO if policy allows	Buyer / requester	After SLA to Procurement Ops	04, 08, 09	A	M
EX-PO-INV	Invalid PO	PO number present but not found or not for this vendor/entity	Typo; wrong PO; recycled number	PO master, vendor, entity	Correct PO or reject	AP Validation + Buyer	High value to Procurement	02, 04	D/A	M
EX-PO-C LSD	PO closed	PO exists but is closed for invoicing	Over-receipt/invoice; early close	PO status, remaining, history	Reopen per policy or credit	Buyer / Procurement	Controller if accrued	03, 06	D	M
EX-PO-EXH	PO exhausted	Value or qty remaining insufficient	Under-ordered; split invoices; price rise	Remaining qty/value, invoice lines	Amend PO or split	Buyer	Category manager if recurring	03, 06	D	M
EX-PRC	Price mismatch	Invoice unit/price differs from PO beyond tolerance	Catalogue error; unapproved increase; UOM	PO price, invoice price, UOM, tolerance	Confirm with buyer; credit; amend	Buyer	Above tolerance band 2 to Procurement	03	D/A	M
EX-QTY	Quantity mismatch	Invoice qty differs from PO/GR	Overship; partial; UOM	PO qty, GR qty, invoice qty	Wait GR; return; credit	Receiver + Buyer	Aged to AP Manager	03, 05	D	M

Code	Name	Definition	Probable root cause	Required data	Suggested resolution	Responsible	Escalation	Agent	Auto	Risk
EX-GR-MISS	Missing receipt	Match needs GR; none posted	Goods not received; receiver delay; service PO misused	PO, GR, location, receiver	Chase receiver; service confirm	Receiver	Manager then site lead	05, 09	A	M
EX-GR-PART	Partial receipt	GR exists but insufficient	Partial delivery; staged project	GR history, invoice	Wait; split; credit	Receiver	Project POs to PM	03, 05	D/A	L
EX-DUP-EX	Duplicate invoice	Exact or policy-exact duplicate	Resubmit; statement chase	Invoice key, paid / open index	Block and notify supplier	AP Validation	Payments if already paid	02, 10	D/A	H
EX-DUP-NEAR	Potential duplicate	Similar features, not exact	Copy/paste; revised invoice; shared amounts	Fuzzy keys, dates, amounts	Human review	AP Controls	If paid path, Payments	10	A	H
EX-VEND	Wrong supplier	Vendor on invoice ≠ expected / PO vendor	Shared remit; factoring; lookalike name	Vendor master, PO vendor, remit	Recode or reject	AP Master Data	Lookalike + bank to Controls	02, 10	A	H
EX-LE	Incorrect legal entity	Bill-to entity ≠ processing entity	Supplier master; shared SSC inbox	Entity directory, bill-to	Redirect; re-register	AP Intake	Tax if cross-border	01, 02	A	H
EX-TAX	Tax issue	VAT/GST / sales tax missing, wrong rate, or arithmetic fail	Supplier error; exemption; jurisdiction	Tax table, entity, vendor tax ID	Supplier correction or tax team	Tax / AP	Tax lead	02	D/A	H
EX-APR-MISS	Approval missing	Required approval not complete	Workflow skip; approver left	Workflow, DOA	Route correctly	Approver	After SLA to delegate admin	07	D	M
EX-DOA	DOA issue	Approver lacks authority or path is wrong	Stale DOA; split invoices	DOA table, amount, account	Re-route; update DOA	Controls	Internal Audit if patterned	07	D	H
EX-COD-MISS	Coding missing	GL / cost object not provided	Non-PO without coding; requester silence	Coding rules, requester	Chase requester	Requester / AP coder	After SLA to cost owner	09	A	M

Code	Name	Definition	Probable root cause	Required data	Suggested resolution	Responsible	Escalation	Agent	Auto	Risk
EX-CC-INV	Invalid cost centre	Cost object closed, wrong entity, or not allowed	Reorg; stale cheat-sheet	Cost object master	Recode	Finance BP	Controller	02, 09	D	M
EX-IQ	Invoice quality	Unreadable, missing pages, non-invoice, mixed docs	Scan; supplier pack	File, page count	Return to supplier	Intake	High value same day	01	A	L
EX-OCR	OCR / extraction issue	Fields extracted wrongly or low confidence	Image quality; unusual layout	Extractor confidences, raw file	Human extract or re-scan	Intake	If systematic, IDP owner	01, 02	A	M
EX-MD	Master-data issue	Vendor / item / tax / bank master blocks processing	Stale master; duplicate vendors	Master records, change log	MDM ticket	Master Data	Bank changes to Controls	02, 10, 12	A	H
EX-BANK	Banking-change concern	Vendor bank or remit change near a payment	Fraud attempt or genuine change	Change log, verification policy	Hold and verify out-of-band	Payments + Controls	CISO/Fraud if unverified	10, 12	A	H
EX-CN	Credit note required	Overcharge, return, or duplicate needs credit	Returns; pricing	Correspondence, RMA	Request credit	Buyer / AP	Aged to AP Manager	08	A	M
EX-STMT	Statement discrepancy	Statement does not agree to AP	Timing; missing invoice; unapplied credit	Statement, AP subledger	Reconcile; request copy	Statements	Material balance to Controller	11	A	M
EX-HOLD	Payment hold	Item on hold (dispute, tax, quality, legal)	Various	Hold code	Manage hold reason	Hold owner	Per hold policy	12	D	H
EX-DISP	Disputed invoice	Business disputes liability	Service quality; contract	Dispute notes	Commercial resolution	Buyer / Legal	Legal if letter before action	04, 08	H	H
EX-AGED	Aged unresolved item	Open beyond policy with no current owner action	Lost ticket; hero left	Age, last action	Re-triage	AP Manager	Steering if systemic	04, 16	A	M

Code	Name	Definition	Probable root cause	Required data	Suggested resolution	Responsible	Escalation	Agent	Auto	Risk
EX-SYS	System / interface error	Integration, lock, period, workflow technical fail	Release, interface, period close	Error codes	IT / support	IT + AP	If payment file, Payments	16	D	M
EX-CUT	Cut-off / completeness	Period-end item affecting completeness or accrual	Late invoice; missing GR	Period, GRNI, statements	Accrue or reject per policy	Close Lead	Controller	13	A	H
EX-UOM	Unit of measure	UOM incompatible without conversion	Catalogue vs invoice	UOM tables	Convert or credit	Buyer	Recurring to MDM	03	D/A	L
EX-CUR	Currency	Invoice currency ≠ PO or unconfigured	Vendor error; FX	Currency tables	Reject or treasury rule	AP / Treasury	Material FX to Treasury	02	D	M
EX-IC	Intercompany	IC invoice fails pairing or policy	Timing; wrong entity	IC guide	IC desk	IC accountant	Controller	02, 13	A	M
EX-PIJ	Prompt-injection / hostile content	Invoice or email attempts to instruct the agent	Malicious or accidental	Raw text	Quarantine, do not follow	Security + AP	CISO	all	H	H

Decision tree (first split)

1. Is the file a valid invoice? No → EX-IQ / EX-OCR
2. Hostile instruction in text? Yes → EX-PIJ
3. Exact duplicate? Yes → EX-DUP-EX
4. Entity / vendor identity fail? → EX-LE / EX-VEND / EX-MD
5. Tax arithmetic or ID fail? → EX-TAX
6. PO required but missing/invalid/closed/exhausted? → PO codes
7. Match fail? Price / qty / GR
8. Approval / DOA / coding?
9. Hold / dispute / statement / close
10. Else EX-AGED or EX-SYS

Starter subset

If you only implement ten codes in week one: EX-PO-MISS, EX-PRC, EX-QTY, EX-GR-MISS, EX-DUP-EX, EX-DUP-NEAR, EX-APR-MISS, EX-COD-MISS, EX-TAX, EX-AGED.

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